

The Cippus Inscriptions of Museo Nazionale di Tarquinia. Materiali del Museo Archeologico Nazionale di Tarquinia XVIII, by Jorma Kaimio

(Rome: Giorgio Bretschneider Editore, 2010). 217 pages.

by Brent Vine

At a time when the study of "Romanization" has become a well established subfield (see recently Dupraz 2010), it is a pleasure to report on an impeccable work of scholarship from Jorma Kaimio, a pioneer in this field (Kaimio 1975). We have here a meticulously prepared edition, with substantial epigraphical commentary, of the Etruscan and Latin funerary cippi in the collection of the Museo Nazionale di Tarquinia (including 39 previously unpublished texts), as well as a catalogue with texts of all other known cippi from Tarquinia. Most of the texts from the Museo are provided with one or more photographs of a squeeze together with a drawing, and the commentary on each text addresses primarily questions of provenance, cippus typology, reading and paleography, onomastics, and dating.

Indeed, dating is one of Kaimio's primary concerns, as the book is much more than a standard text edition. A substantial introduction on "The Dating of the Cippus Inscriptions" (pp. 5-30) begins with a detailed study of the typology of the cippi, and goes on to analyze the contribution of nearly a dozen other dating criteria to be extracted from the material. In a concluding essay on "The Tarquinian Tradition of Cippi Inscriptions" (pp. 189-98), Kaimio summarizes the results of his dating analyses, and draws further conclusions about the cultural contexts of these texts, based on comparative studies with other cippi traditions (such as at Praeneste or Caere) and on the onomastic evidence of the texts themselves.

Kaimio uncovers much of interest, including the occasional new reading: thus for No. 57 (pp. 86-7), Kaimio rejects *lucer,* accepted by all previous editors (including Rix in *ET*), and argues in favor of a praenomen *ucer,* to be compared with the same stem as seen in onomastic forms like *ucernei, ucrini,* and the cognomen *ucar.* The rich onomastic data are not only important in themselves, but also for their sociolinguistic ramifications: note, for example, some interesting cross-linguistic trends Kaimio has been able to trace, such as his conclusions (pp. 28-9) concerning the popularity of *Sextus* and *L(ucius)* in the Latin material as a reflection of the corresponding popularity of Etruscan *e re* and *l(ar).* Among other "sociological features" Kaimio

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highlights (pp. 29-30, and passim in his concluding essay, pp. 189ff.), particularly intriguing is the markedly high proportion of women named in both the Etruscan and Latin cippi (about 40%, as against 24% in material from Caere), together with other differences between the two bodies of texts (such as the proportion of freedmen and the distribution of particular gentilicia).

As Kaimio notes (p. 2), he has followed standard epigraphical practices, which differ somewhat on the Latin and Etruscan sides, for his transcriptions of material in those languages. This choice cannot be faulted. Yet his material points up some of the limitations of these conventions, particularly for Latin. Thus, in such *CIL*-style notations, there is no indication of *I* longa or of cursive lettering, and no representation of punctuation or indentation. Yet all of these are potentially of some interest for Republican and early Imperial inscriptions. The problem is mitigated here not only by the presence of the photographs and drawings, but also by the fact that for the lettering Kaimio generally provides explicit descriptions detailing the presence of *I* longa, cursive *E*, and other such features. Yet his attention to these matters is somewhat uneven. Consider as illustration No. 22 (pp. 51-2; late 1st c. BC), for which Kaimio offers the following transcription:

Pomponia C(ai) f(ilia)
Posilla
vixit annis
XX

The text is of a standard type, and Kaimio is careful to note the *I* longa in *annis.* But to judge from the two photos provided, a more inclusive rendering might be as follows:

Pomponia.C(ai)f(ilia)[
Posilla.
vixit[]annis.
XX[]

There is no indication, in Kaimio's description, of the careful centering technique (which may be an indication of lateness, in comparison with earlier texts of this type; I discuss elsewhere the development of earlier "pre-centering" indentation patterns, 1993:106ff.); nor is there any mention of the unusual punctuation style, which includes not only line-end puncts in the second and third lines (the status of lines one and four is unclear, because of the lack of space at the end of line one and a groove after "*XX*" in line four), but also what I have termed a "complex" punctuation pattern, in which more than one "level" of punctuation, so to speak, is used. Here, according to a pattern well attested elsewhere (including in Praenestine cippi and in the *tituli Caeretani*; Vine 1993:356ff.), the patronymic expression *C(ai)f(ilia)* (i.e. "CF") is treated as a unit, without internal punctuation, as opposed to the word-dividing puncts separating all other items (with the possible exception of the space between *vixit* and *annis,* where again the groove renders the punctuation uncertain; see also below on this formulaic phrase).

Indeed, thanks in part to Kaimio's careful descriptions, one may suggest that the profile of "complex punctuation" in these texts (both Etruscan and Latin) may be more robust than

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his commentary indicates:

• For No. 65 (Etruscan), Kaimio observes (p. 96) that "*ET* wants to see double dots between the words, but at the most the first interpunctuation is double (if the lower dot is not incidental), the rest single" — a pattern of what amounts to "complex punctuation" reminiscent of a type that is found, for example, in Faliscan (Vine 1993:362ff.). Similarly for some Latin instances:

• For No. 86, Kaimio notes (p. 119) that "[t]he first dot is a small horizontal stroke, the others are round" — thus here S-CORO / CN.L (i.e. "*S(ervius) Coro(na) / Cn(aei) l(ibertus)*") matches the complex type that differentiates horizontal stroke and dot within naming-expressions, as in, for example, *CIL* I² 321 TITOLEIAI-M.F (cipp. Praen.), among other instances of this type (Vine 1993:354ff.).

• No. 98 (pp. 132-3) elicits no comment from Kaimio on the punctuation; but side by side with standard word-dividing dots in the naming expressions, the text appears to show "VA" (i.e. "*v(ixit) a(nnos)*") without internal punctuation — an interesting datum for this fixed formula, otherwise normally "V.A" when so abbreviated.

• For No. 101, Kaimio comments (p. 136) that "[a]t least the first punctuation shows a double dot in the Etruscan style" — which again amounts to a naming expression with "complex punctuation", i.e. "L:STATE / L.F" (cf. on No. 65 above). The issue is perhaps not without interest in connection with the interpretation of STATE here as Roman (e.g. *State(rius)*) or Etruscan (*State*, the interpretation Kaimio favors).

As with *I* longa and many features of punctuation, Kaimio is careful to record, in his commentary, instances of two-bar cursive *E* (i.e. "II", invisible, of course, in the *CIL*-style transcriptions), a type of lettering he finds to be rare in the cippi from Tarquinia, although common in Tuscania (pp. 122, 150, and similarly p. 60 on a probable cursive *F*; further instances of cursive *E* appear in Nos. 181 [p. 165], 201 [p. 168], and possibly 205 [p. 168]). One wonders, however, whether the problematic and hitherto unknown gentilicium "*Saienus*" (No. 36 [p. 64], in one of the "disappeared unpublished" cippi, with facsimiles provided from transcriptions in the museum's Inventory Catalogue) might call for a solution involving cursive *E.* Kaimio proposes an original "*Sa enus*", and offers the alternative suggestion that in *Saienus* "perhaps we have a variant of *Saenius*" (common in Etruria). But Weiss (2010) points out that "it is hard to see how *Saienus* could simply be a variant of *Saenius*", and concludes that the reading should be emended either to *Sa enus* or ("somewhat less plausibly") *Saenius.* For the latter, however, an original SAIINIVS, with cursive *E*, might well have been misread as "*Saienus*" by the museum transcriber. (The same text also records "SEX." in the patronymic; but even if the *E* is correctly transcribed, both "E" and "II" can co-exist in the same text, a feature well-attested for a number of areas, including Etruria [Vine 1993:345ff.]) Note finally that this text also features a transcription with both dash and dot ("SAIENUS-SEX.F."), which may be quite accurate, in view of the above discussion of "complex punctuation" (see especially on No. 86 above).

A final point related to lettering and orthography concerns text No. 19, for which Kaimio observes (p. 48) that "[t]he abbreviation of the father's praenomen *S(e)xs(ti)* is not … met elsewhere". Here one might consider a solution involving "syllabic notation" (whether "S" = "*S(e)*" or "X" = "*(e)x*"); see my discussion (1993:323ff., including 342f. on the use of syllabic notation with "semivowels" [*l, r, m, n*] and *h, s, t*), and note the possible existence of an Etruscan

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instance involving "s" = "*s(e)*" (i.e. *s(e)ianti* [*ET* Cl 1.2227]; Wallace 1997:247). It is suggestive, moreover, that syllabic notation is well-attested in other cippi traditions, as in Praeneste.

A minor blemish: there are some page references to the 1928 edition of Leumann's handbook of Latin historical phonology and morphology (p. 26, fn. 76) that do not match the 1977 edition, despite the fact that the bibliography (p. 202) records "Leumann 1928" as if it were the same item as Leumann 1977. But in most other respects, the book has been beautifully produced: the lavish photographs and drawings are generally of high quality, and there are almost no typographical errors; worth noting among those is perhaps "*mil(litum)*" [sic] in text No. 161 (p. 162). One may regret, to bring these cavils to an end, that Kaimio's "recognizably non-native" English (thus correctly Weiss 2010) was not edited by a native speaker; but the resulting infelicities and solecisms (e.g., among many others, "reusal" [p. 8 and passim, for the noun "reuse"], "aspirant variation" [p. 87, for "variation in aspiration" or "aspirate variation"], "Etruscanity" [p. 190]) do not impede understanding. These are after all mere trivialities, when one considers that, as another reviewer has put it (López Montero 2010), "Kaimio makes the cippi talk" — a remarkable feat; and we should listen.

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